

Cybersecurity Daily Newsletter

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Top 5 Highlights

- OpenAI commits \$1B in AI credits to frontline cyber defenders
- French hospital fined €500,000 after breach exposes data of 727,000
- OpenAI targets small utilities with \$1 billion cyber defense initiative
- Incident response guide for AWS CloudTrail investigations - Part 2
- Introducing context-aware vulnerability discovery and remediation with Cloudflare Managed Defense and OpenAI Daybreak models

Threat Intelligence (10)

01. Phishing campaign targets widely used RMM platforms in 46 countries

Phishing attacks trick victims into installing legitimate RMM tools for remote access.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources:

<https://www.scworld.com/news/phishing-campaign-targets-widely-used-rmm-platforms-in-46-countries>

02. ThreatsDay: CEO Phishing Kits, 5K Dropbox Account Hacks, OAuth Traps + 17 More Stories

The worst part is how normal these attacks look. A call from IT. A shared file. A trusted app. A simple request to click "Allow." Why break in when someone might open the door? That idea runs through this edition. Attackers use real tools, fake login pages, old account links, and software guides that point to unsafe downloads. One wrong letter in a web addr...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/threatsday-ceo-phishing-kits-5k-dropbox.html>

03. StreamRat Android malware spreads through Meta and TikTok ads

Social media ads for a free streaming service exposed roughly 570,000 people to StreamRat, a banking Trojan that can take control of infected phones.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.malwarebytes.com/blog/news/2026/09/streamrat-android-malware-spreads-through-meta-and-tiktok-ads>

04. ASCII smuggling crosses over from AI prompt injection to phishing evasion

Invisible Unicode characters popularized for hiding instructions from AI models are now being used to obfuscate words before email filters parse them. The post ASCII smuggling crosses over from AI prompt injection to phishing evasion appeared first on Microsoft Security Blog .

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/security/blog/2026/09/03/ascii-smuggling-crosses-over-from-a-i-prompt-injection-to-phishing-evasion/>

05. BraZetsu Malware Turns Compromised Windows Hosts Into Criminal Marketplace Inventory

Cybersecurity researchers have disclosed details of a sophisticated Python-based Windows malware framework called BraZetsu that fuels an underground marketplace commercializing access to compromised hosts. "Unlike the standard infostealer model, BraZetsu is a comprehensive master toolkit that empowers Initial Access Brokers (IABs) by turning compromised sys...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/brazetsu-malware-turns-compromised.html>

06. New 'Spring Ring' operation uses vishing via Microsoft Teams

The "Spring Ring" operation, observed between January and April, illustrates a shift from traditional email phishing to attacks leveraging trusted enterprise collaboration platforms like Microsoft Teams.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/new-spring-ring-operation-uses-vishing-via-microsoft-teams>

07. Outsider Phishing Kit Survives Takedown With 700 New Pages

Outsider phishing kit generated 700 new pages after a Google-led disruption

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/outsider-phishing-kit-survives/>

08. AI Agent Firewall Startup AIR Security Emerges From Stealth With \$50 Million

The startup's firewall evaluates AI skills, plugins and MCP servers for malicious instructions, excessive permissions and software supply chain risks. The post AI Agent Firewall Startup AIR Security Emerges From Stealth With \$50 Million appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Audit build pipelines, rotate CI/CD secrets, enforce package integrity controls, and review developer workstation hardening.

Sources: <https://www.securityweek.com/ai-agent-firewall-startup-air-security-emerges-from-stealth-with-50-million/>

09. US Becomes Top Target in RMM Phishing Campaign Spanning 46 Countries

An RMM phishing campaign initially associated with Canadian targeting due to its use of Canada Revenue Agency (CRA) tax forms as lures has turned out to be part of a broader campaign spanning 46 countries. Around 45% of observed activity was associated with the United States, making it the campaign's top geographic target. ANY.RUN research connected 601 cas...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/us-becomes-top-target-in-rmm-phishing.html>

10. Counterfeit installers turn routine software downloads into enterprise breaches

Microsoft has warned that attackers are breaching enterprise systems via counterfeit download sites impersonating software including Microsoft Edge, Kaspersky and Razer, delivering trojanized installers for persistent access. "Once executed, the malicious installers deploy malware that establishes persistence, attempts to weaken security protections, and co...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.csoonline.com/article/4218075/counterfeit-installers-turn-routine-software-downloads-into-enterprise-breaches.html>

Latest Vulnerabilities (10)

01. OpenAI commits \$1B in AI credits to frontline cyber defenders

Daybreak program brings subsidized models, training, and support to under-resourced teams

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/security/2026/09/04/openai-commits-1b-in-ai-credits-to-frontline-cyber-defenders/5294382>

02. OpenAI targets small utilities with \$1 billion cyber defense initiative

In a keynote speech during a summit at OpenAI's headquarters attended by 300 enterprise security leaders and CISOs from Fortune 1000 companies, OpenAI President

Greg Brockman announced Daybreak for Frontline Defenders, a new global initiative to help frontline defenders use frontier cyber AI to protect essential services in the United States and around the...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.csoonline.com/article/4218373/openai-targets-small-utilities-with-1-billion-cyber-defense-initiative.html>

03. Introducing context-aware vulnerability discovery and remediation with Cloudflare Managed Defense and OpenAI Daybreak models

Use production traffic and security signals to prioritize findings, prepare edge mitigations when safe, and propose code patches. By combining WAF data with OpenAI Daybreak models, Vulnerability Discovery and Remediation helps teams identify and patch the most critical threats first.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://blog.cloudflare.com/vulnerability-discovery-remediation/>

04. HPE patches critical ArubaOS-CX remote code execution flaw

Hewlett Packard Enterprise (HPE) has patched a critical vulnerability in the ArubaOS-CX network operating system that could lead to remote code execution. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/hpe-patches-critical-arubaos-cx-remote-code-execution-flaw/>

05. Prolific Microsoft 0-day hunter drops CrowdStrike Falcon exploit PoC

A shared security 'Nightmare'

Why it matters: Publicly discussed 0-days often see rapid weaponization, increasing the risk of opportunistic attacks at scale.

Recommendation: Apply vendor guidance immediately, reduce attack surface, and monitor for IoCs/exploitation telemetry until patches are fully deployed.

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/security/2026/09/03/prolific-microsoft-0-day-hunter-drops-crowdstrike-falcon-exploit-poc/5294318>

06. VU#889462: Casdoor authentication server is vulnerable to authorization bypass

Overview Casdoor is an open-source Access Management (IAM) platform used to manage web applications. An authorization bypass vulnerability affects Casdoor versions 3.115.0 and earlier. The vulnerability allows a non-global organization administrator to perform unauthorized administrative actions against arbitrary organizations by exploiting inconsistent obj...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://kb.cert.org/vuls/id/889462>

07. Critical Cisco Nexus 9000 Flaw Lets Unauthenticated Remote Attackers Run Code as Root

Cisco has released patches to address a critical security flaw affecting 10 Silicon One-based Nexus 9000 switches that could allow an unauthenticated, remote attacker to execute code as root, alongside an IOS XR hardening release bundling 7 umbrella CVEs, 2 of which are rated 9.8, with no workaround for any IOS XR version. The Nexus vulnerability, tracked a...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/critical-cisco-nexus-9000-flaw-lets.html>

08. Pegasus Zero-Click Exploit Infects Serbian Student Activist's iPhone

Pegasus infected a Serbian student activist's iPhone through an iMessage zero-click exploit

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/pegasus-zero-click-exploit/>

09. Drowning in CVEs and thirsty for answers? Try CTEM

SPONSORED FEATURE: Boards want to know if they're less exposed than last quarter. Patching metrics aren't the solution

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/security/2026/09/03/sponsored-drowning-in-cves-and-thirsty-for-answers-try-ctem/5293906>

10. Critical Elementor Pro flaw exploited to take over WordPress sites

A recently patched critical vulnerability (CVE-2026-32475) in the Elementor Pro plugin for WordPress is being exploited in attacks that deliver a webshell payload and execute arbitrary commands on the server. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/critical-elementor-pro-flaw-exploited-to-take-over-wordpress-sites/>

Data Breach & Cybercrime (10)

01. French hospital fined €500,000 after breach exposes data of 727,000

France's data protection authority (CNIL) has fined Hôpital privé de la Loire €500,000 (\$580,000) for failing to adequately protect patients' and their relatives' data. [...]

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/french-hospital-fined-500-000-after-breach-exposes-data-of-727-000/>

02. Incident response guide for AWS CloudTrail investigations - Part 2

In Part 1 of this guide, we examined two common incident scenarios: cross-account Amazon Simple Storage Service (Amazon S3) data deletion with ransomware implications, and cryptocurrency mining deployed through AWS CloudFormation using exposed AWS Management Console credentials. We also introduced key incident response terminology and investigative framework...

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources:

<https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/security/incident-response-guide-for-aws-cloudtrail-investigations-part-2/>

03. Large Enterprises Targeted in Fake Merger & Acquisition Scams

Threat actors behind the "Phantom Deal" campaign are studying companies in extreme detail, aiming to dupe midlevel employees into initiating large financial transfers.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/cyberattacks-data-breaches/large-enterprises-fake-merger-acquisition-scams>

04. What We Missed: Did ShinyHunters 'Breach' ReliaQuest?

In this video conversation, Dark Reading editors discuss some of the news they didn't get a chance to cover, from the latest antics of ShinyHunters to new research about the prevalence (or lack thereof) of AI-generated malware.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/cybersecurity-operations/what-we-missed-did-shinyhunters-breach-reliaquest>

05. Manchester Airports Group Data on 8.8 Million People Leaked After Ransom Refusal

Hacker group published roughly 550GB of data after MAG reportedly refused to pay a ransom demand; the group says it gained access via exposed admin keys. The post Manchester Airports Group Data on 8.8 Million People Leaked After Ransom Refusal appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.securityweek.com/manchester-airports-group-data-on-8-8-million-people-leaked-after-ransom-refusal/>

06. Thomson Reuters Court Software Breach May Have Exposed SSNs and Sealed Data

Thomson Reuters disclosed on Wednesday that an unauthorized party obtained files from C-Track, the court case management platform sold by its West Publishing Corporation unit, in March 2026, affecting courts in 11 U.S. states, the U.S. Virgin Islands, and Ontario, Canada. West Publishing said it discovered the activity on June 30, 2026. A subset of court re...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/thomson-reuters-court-software-breach.html>

07. AI 'Machine Speed' Cuts 2-Week Attack Down to 10 Hours

The incident demonstrates how frontier AI agents can dramatically compress an attack timeline and coordinate a large-scale breach, according to researchers.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources:

<https://www.darkreading.com/cyberattacks-data-breaches/ai-machine-speed-2-week-attack-10-hours>

08. Your Employee's Password Appeared in an Infostealer Log. Now What?

Infostealers can expose far more than passwords, including authenticated sessions that may let attackers bypass MFA. Flare explains how defenders can prioritize compromised identities, determine whether stolen access is still usable, and respond before it leads to account takeover. [...]

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/your-employees-password-appeared-in-an-infostealer-log-now-what/>

09. Thomson Reuters reveals breach that exposed U.S. and Canadian court records

Thomson Reuters has disclosed a data breach affecting C-Track, a court case management platform operated by its subsidiaries, exposing court records and sensitive personal information across courts in at least 12 US states, the US Virgin Islands, and Canada. The company published the disclosure publicly on Wednesday, along with separate notification pages f...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/09/03/thomson-reuters-reveals-breach-that-exposed-u-s-and-canadian-court-records/>

10. US and Canadian Court Records Breached Following Thomson Reuters Incident

Thomson Reuters has disclosed a cyber incident affecting its C-Track court management software, potentially exposing court records in Canada and the US

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/us-canada-court-breach-thomson/>